

Comfortably Numb -- Pink Floyd

The Wall, 1979. ~64 BPM.

GP-5 only, P/J bass, no pedalboard.

The bass part is slow, long, sustained notes under an orchestral verse and Gilmour's huge chorus/solo sections. It has to be deep, round, and smooth, and fill the floor under the whole arrangement without ever getting busy or bright.

Verses sit in B minor with strings. The "I have become comfortably numb" choruses and both solos open up in D major.

AMP: Mess Bass (Mesa/Boogie Bass 400) + CAB: Apg115410 IR (User IR 2)

This isn't a period-correct pick. It's a tonal one.

Bass 400 gives a smooth, full-range, hi-fi low end that fits the big, polished production on this record.

Apg115410 is a summed B-15 + 410: flat and thunderous. That's what whole-note roots under an orchestra need.

- Gain: 25. Clean.
- Bass: 62. Deep. This part lives on the low end.
- Middle: 48. Slightly pulled back so the strings and vocal have space.
- Treble: 40. Round and dark. No finger clack.
- VOL: 65. CAB VOL: 60.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 12. Very light. Long sustained notes must decay naturally, so the gate can't cut the tails.

PRE -- COMP (Ross), always on.

Sustain: 40, VOL: 60.

Light compression evens out the long notes so every root holds the same weight across the bar.

DST -- Bass OD, on CTL.

Gain: 15, Blend: 30, VOL: 60, Bass: 55, Treble: 45.

Very light. It doesn't really read as overdrive.

It adds some harmonic density so the bass holds its ground under the chorus and the final solo wall.

AMP -- Mess Bass, always on. Gain 25, Bass 62, Middle 48, Treble 40, VOL 65.

CAB -- User IR 2 (Apg115410), always on. VOL 60.

EQ -- Bass EQ 1, always on.

33Hz: +3, 150Hz: +2, 600Hz: -2, 2kHz: 0, 8kHz: -3, VOL: 52.

Sub and low end reinforced, 600Hz cleared of boxiness, top rolled off.

The result is a round, felt-more-than-heard bottom.

MOD -- off.

DLY -- off. Gilmour has the delay. The bass doesn't need it.

RVB -- Hall, on CTL.

Mix: 22, Decay: 50, Trail: on.

Opens the bass into the same big space as the chorus and solos. Trail on lets the tail ring out when you drop back into a verse.

CTL footswitch

Two modules on CTL: DST (Bass OD) and RVB (Hall).

- **CTL off**: verses ("Hello, is there anybody in there?"). Dry, deep, and smooth under the strings. This is the resting state.
- **CTL on**: choruses and both guitar solos. A little extra density plus hall space to match the band's lift.

Engage at each "There is no pain, you are receding" chorus entry and leave it on through the solos. Back off for the verses.